

UNBOUND

Species & Bio-Engineering System

Design Reference v4.3 · RHabit Game Development

Universe-agnostic framework grounded in the five kingdoms of biological life and evolutionary economics.

System Overview

Every creature in Unbound is defined by three layers. The **Morphotype** is the body plan — what evolution built. The **Biology Type** is the taxonomic lineage — what kingdom and family the creature belongs to, advancing through Ranks 1–5 as the creature matures. The **Lineage Archetype** is the cultural and epigenetic inheritance — what the creature’s ancestors survived through, shaping Rank 1 trait tendencies before individual choice begins.

#	Component	Function
1	Morphotype	Body plan. Grants equipment slots, free innate traits, torso scale, and the TP Compensation Pool. Set at creation.
2	Biology Type	Taxonomic family within one of the five kingdoms. Rank 1 granted free. Ranks 2–5 purchased at Stat Rank XP curve ($R \times R+1$). Distributes pool TP per rank.
3	Lineage Archetype	Cultural and epigenetic heritage. Recommends Rank 1 variation traits from the pool. Not mandatory — a starting conversation, not a constraint.
4	Traits	Purchased with TP from the Compensation Pool. Organized into trees with prerequisites, rank gates, and incompatibilities.
5	Advanced Biology	Post-Awakening transformation. Stat Rank XP curve. Unlocks [Advanced] traits. Replaces or extends base Biology Type.
+	Size	Tiny through Gigantic. Affects SPD, area, and cross-size BDY/SPT combat modifiers.
+	Diet	One selection filtered by kingdom tag. Grants Max HP/SP/MP bonuses from lifelong feeding adaptation.

Resource Economy

Max Pool and Regen Rate come from distinct sources. This distinction is fundamental to building and reading any species.

Source	Grants	Philosophy
Stats (BDY/SPT/MND)	Max Pool	Primary driver. Each die = 4 for simplified calculations.
Diet	Max Pool	Lifelong feeding strategy. The longest-running experience of any creature's life sets their capacity baseline.
Rank (Level 2+)	Max Pool	Rank ² increase per skill. 3 XP → +4, 6 XP → +9, 10 XP → +16, 15 XP → +25.
Affinity / Proficiency Skills	Regen Rate	Learned experience through repetition that rebuilds the body stronger.
Biology Traits (TP)	Regen + Max (Creation)	Inherited biological efficiency. Regen is the primary TP expression. Max pool traits are rare genetic outliers — [Creation] only.
Torso Scale	SPR only	The cardiovascular engine. SPR only — no innate MPR. Morphotype-defined at creation.
Limbs	Costs Regen / Max	Resting metabolic cost of maintaining the inherited body plan.

TP / XP Conversion

Conversion Rates

Spending TP on traits: 4 TP = 1 XP equivalent (biology is efficient when lived)

Unspent TP pool → Starter XP: 6 TP = 1 XP (unused biology loses value — use it)

Starter XP → TP: 6 TP = 1 XP (buying biology through study is inefficient)

Adaptable trait: grants 1 XP per 4 TP unspent (biological plasticity outlier)

The asymmetry is intentional. A creature who ignores their biological inheritance recovers less than one who leans into it. Evolution invested in you — the question is whether you invest back.

Limb Metabolic Costs

Recorded on the character sheet at creation. Resting metabolic overhead — not the cost of using limbs in action.

Limb	Cost per Pair	Reasoning
Arms	-1 SPR	Manipulation overhead. Efficient — evolved for precision not endurance.
Legs	-2 SPR	Load-bearing locomotion. Highest resting metabolic cost of any limb type.
Wings	-1 Max SP	Weight at rest only. Flying costs additional SP per round separately.
Forelimb Claws	-1 SPR	Lighter than full arms. Limited grip reduces metabolic requirement.

Tail — Thick	-1 SPR	Significant mass with constant resting muscle tension.
Tail — Prehensile	0	Minimal mass. Low resting overhead.
Serpentine Tail (replaces legs)	-1 SPR	Half the cost of legs. Undulation is metabolically efficient.

Torso Scale

Defined per morphotype at creation. Grants SPR only — no innate MPR. MPR recovery comes from traits (Gut-Brain Axis, Sleep Architecture, Glial Density, etc.).

Scale	SPR	Example Morphotypes
Vestigial	0	Insects, minimal-trunk creatures
Small	+1	Avian, Arachnid, small humanoids
Standard	+2	Humanoid, Bipedal Beast, Amphibian, Molluscoid, Sylvan Form
Large	+3	Quadruped, Tauric, Hexapod, Ambulatory
Massive	+4	Trent, True Dragon, Serpentine, Serpentine Hybrid
Colossal	+5	Rooted, Elemental Form, Gigantic creatures

Morphotype Economic Framework

Every morphotype has a **Score** measured against the **Cap of 64 TP**. The Compensation Pool = max(0, 64 – Score). Scores are built from three components only — slot grants, size, and free innate traits. No abstract discounts. Every point corresponds to something visible on the sheet.

Score Formula

Score = Slot Grant Value + Size Value + Free Innate Trait Value

No discount modifiers. No abstract budget adjustments.

Every TP in the score is a slot, a size category, or a named trait.

Free traits are traits the creature has from birth — non-negotiable biology.

Variation traits come from the pool — individual expression through Biology Ranks.

Starting XP Reduction

Morphotypes with scores significantly above Humanoid (52) have more biological capital at creation. Starting XP reduces at 1 XP per 4 TP above 52 to compensate.

Score Range	XP Reduction	Starting XP	Design Intent
0–52	0	16 XP	Standard. Humanoid and below.
53–56	–1 XP	15 XP	Minor biological advantage.
57–60	–2 XP	14 XP	Moderate biological depth.
61–64	–3 XP	13 XP	Significant. Near cap.
65+ (True Dragon: 63)	–4 XP	12 XP	True Dragon territory. Biology IS the character at start.

Slot Grant TP Values

Slot Grant	TP	Notes
Hands (per pair)	6	Fine manipulation, weapons, tools. Highest utility slot.
Arms (per pair)	3	Infrastructure for Hands. –1 SPR per pair on character sheet.
Wings (per pair)	6	New movement dimension. –1 Max SP per pair on character sheet.
Feet / Talons (per pair)	3	Footwear, movement gear, kick weapons.
Forelimb Claws (per pair)	2	Limited grip. –1 SPR per pair on character sheet.
Legs (per pair)	2	Near-universal structural. –2 SPR per pair on character sheet.
Head/Neck	3	Head, Neck, Face as bundle. Standard vertebrate.
Head (basic)	1	Head and face only — no neck. Fish-type or simple morphologies.
Neck (standalone)	1	Collar/gorget slot only.
Extended Neck	3	Long-necked morphologies. Grants neck segments for banded armor.
Torso/Back	2	Torso, Back, Waist. Near-universal baseline.
Natural Weapons	3	One natural weapon type without slot cost.

Tail — Thick	2	Heavy tail slot. Can be armored. –1 SPR on character sheet.
Tail — Thin/Prehensile	2	Prehensile grants one-action-per-turn Grip slot. 0 SPR cost.
Proboscis	1	Feeding tube. Enables feeding equipment or venom delivery.
Gill Slits	1	Aquatic breathing. Pairs with swim locomotion.
Pouch	1	Marsupial storage/young-carrying slot.
Fin (standalone)	1	Dorsal, pectoral, or caudal fin for aquatic stabilization gear.
Spinneret	2	Web-production. Enables silk equipment and trap-setting actions.
Venom Gland	2	Enables venom modification via crafting. Distinct from Venomous trait.
Sensory Antennae	2	Antenna slot for sensory augmentation gear.
Chromatophore Layer	3	Active camouflage organ. Color/pattern modification gear.
Bioluminescent Organ	2	Light-producing slot. Signaling and illumination gear.
Electric Organ	3	Bioelectric generation. Shock attacks and EM sensing gear.
Symbiote Port [Exotic]	4	Biological interface for symbiotic organisms or tech integration.
Sonar Array [Exotic]	3	Biological sonar. Active echolocation gear.
Prehensile Trunk	4	Trunk plus one-action-per-turn Grip slot.
Tentacles	5	Tentacle, Grip, and Ring slots. Variable count.
Broad Back	2	Extra Back mount slot for rider or strapped gear.

Size TP Values

Size	TP	SPD	Area	Investment	Note
Tiny	0	2	1 ft	Minimal biological infrastructure	GM approval
Small	2	3	2 ft	Basic vertebrate-scale systems	
Medium	4	4	4 ft	Standard — Humanoid reference	Default
Large	6	5	8 ft	Significant structural complexity	
Huge	10	6	16 ft	Major biological commitment	GM approval
Gigantic	16	7	32 ft	Near-total budget in size alone	GM approval

Morphotype Reference

Score = Slots + Size + Free Traits. Pool = 64 – Score. Starting XP reduces at 1 XP per 4 TP above score 52. Free traits are innate — present at birth. Variation traits come from the pool through Biology Ranks.

Fauna Morphotypes

Morphotype	Slots	Size	Free	Score	Pool	Torso	Strt XP	MPR Net
Humanoid	33	4	15	52	12	Std	16	+2
Bipedal Beast	36	4	5	45	19	Std	16	0
Tauric	37	6	4	47	17	Lrg	16	0
Quadruped	24	4	5	33	31	Lrg	16	0
Avian	27	2	8	37	27	Sml	16	0
Hexapod	34	4	5	43	21	Lrg	16	0
Serpentine Hybrid	25	4	5	34	30	Msv	16	0
Arachnid	18	2	6	26	38	Sml	16	0
Serpentine	10	4	7	21	43	Msv	16	0
Amphibian	16	2	7	25	39	Std	16	0
Molluscoid	11	2	9	22	42	Std	16	0
True Dragon	41	10	12	63	1	Msv	12	0
Elemental Form	6	4	8	18	46	Col	16	0

Flora Morphotypes

Morphotype	Slots	Size	Free	Score	Pool	Torso	Strt XP	MPR Net
Rooted	6	10	9	25	39	Col	16	0
Ambulatory	12	6	5	23	41	Lrg	16	0
Sylvan Form	33	4	9	46	18	Std	16	0
Trent	14	6	9	29	35	Msv	16	0

Morphotype Free Trait Lists

Free traits are innate — present at birth before any Biology Rank investment. They define the non-negotiable biological baseline of the morphotype. Variation traits come from the Compensation Pool through Biology Ranks.

Humanoid

Free Traits — Score 52, Pool 12, MPR +2

Tool User (T1, PHY) — Primate-level tool use. Genetic, not cultural.
Endurance Runner (T1, PHY) — Bipedal persistence hunting physiology.
Memory Recall (T1, MNT) — Human episodic memory depth.
Keen Perception — Sight (T2, MNT) — Trichromatic color vision, forward-facing eyes.
Warm-Blooded (T1, PHY) — Endothermic. Active in all temperatures.
Instinctual Signaling (T1, SOC) — Baseline emotional communication.
Vocalizer (T2, SOC) — Learned sound production. Physical apparatus for language.
Language (T3, MNT) — Full symbolic communication. -1 MPR.
Sleep Architecture (T2, MNT) — REM sleep cognitive recovery. MPR +2. Requires sleep.
Gut-Brain Axis (T1, MNT) — Enteric nervous system cognitive pathway. MPR +1.
MPR net: -1 (Language) +2 (Sleep Architecture) +1 (Gut-Brain Axis) = +2 MPR

Bipedal Beast

Free Traits — Score 45, Pool 19, MPR 0

Fang/Claw (T1, PHY) — Natural predator or prey weapons.
Keen Smell (T1, MNT) — Scent-dominant sensory system.
Warm-Blooded (T1, PHY) — Endothermic.
Instinctual Signaling (T1, SOC) — Pack/herd communication.
Endurance Runner (T1, PHY) — Active pursuit or flight physiology.
Language is a pool purchase — whether a Bipedal Beast speaks is a Biology Rank choice.

Tauric

Free Traits — Score 47, Pool 17, MPR 0

Warm-Blooded (T1, PHY) — Endothermic.
Endurance Runner (T1, PHY) — Four-legged endurance.
Instinctual Signaling (T1, SOC) — Herd communication baseline.
Hooves (T1, PHY) — Sturdy footing on hard terrain. +1 SPD on stone/packed earth.
Tauric sapience and language are pool purchases — earned through Biology Rank investment.

Quadruped

Free Traits — Score 33, Pool 31, MPR 0

Fang/Claw (T1, PHY) — Natural weapons.
Keen Smell (T1, MNT) — Scent-dominant.
Warm-Blooded (T1, PHY) — Endothermic.
Endurance Runner (T1, PHY) — Pursuit or flight specialist.
Wide-Angle Vision (T1, MNT) — Prey-awareness or predator field coverage.
Largest pool after Serpentine and Elemental Form. Quadruped identity lives in Biology Rank expression.

Avian

Free Traits — Score 37, Pool 27, MPR 0

Hollow Bones (T1, PHY) — Low weight, essential for flight.

Keen Perception — Sight (T2, MNT) — Exceptional visual acuity.
Warm-Blooded (T1, PHY) — Endothermic. High metabolic rate supports flight.
Instinctual Signaling (T1, SOC) — Bird song baseline.
Avian Wings (T3, PHY) — Innate flight-capable wing morphology.

Hexapod

Free Traits — Score 43, Pool 21, MPR 0

Exoskeleton (T2, PHY) — Rigid external armor.
Groundsense (T1, MNT) — Vibration detection through substrate.
Wide-Angle Vision (T1, MNT) — Compound eye coverage.
Cold Blooded (T1, PHY) — Ectothermic.
Head (basic) — no Language cost possible. Hexapod sapience requires Advanced Biology.

Serpentine Hybrid

Free Traits — Score 34, Pool 30, MPR 0

Fang/Claw (T1, PHY) — Fangs for venom delivery.
Venomous (T2, PHY) — Innate venom. Prereq: Fang/Claw ✓
Instinctual Signaling (T1, SOC) — Chemical and sound signaling.
Cold Blooded (T1, PHY) — Ectothermic.
Language is a pool purchase — a speaking naga is built through Biology Rank investment.

Arachnid

Free Traits — Score 26, Pool 38, MPR 0

Exoskeleton (T2, PHY) — Rigid external armor.
Venomous (T2, PHY) — Innate venom.
Groundsense (T1, MNT) — Vibration detection.
Wide-Angle Vision (T1, MNT) — Multi-eye coverage.
Head (basic) — no Language cost possible. Arachnid sapience requires Advanced Biology.

Serpentine

Free Traits — Score 21, Pool 43, MPR 0

Fang/Claw (T1, PHY) — Strike weapon.
Venomous (T2, PHY) — Innate venom.
Cold Blooded (T1, PHY) — Ectothermic.
Constrict (T2, PHY) — Whole-body grapple. Prereq: Serpentine Tail ✓
Groundsense (T1, MNT) — Vibration detection through scales.
Largest Fauna pool. Identity lives almost entirely in Biology Rank expression.
A speaking serpentine: buy Instinctual Signaling → Vocalizer → Language from pool.
Language then unlocks Gut-Brain Axis (torso qualifies as Massive).

Amphibian

Free Traits — Score 25, Pool 39, MPR 0

Amphibious (T2, PHY) — Equal swim and walk speed.
Webbed (T1, PHY) — Interdigital webbing. Prereq for Amphibious ✓
Mucous Coat (T1, PHY) — Skin moisture barrier.
Cold Blooded (T1, PHY) — Ectothermic.
Regenerant (T2, PHY) — Axolotl-lineage baseline regeneration.

Molluscoid

Free Traits — Score 22, Pool 42, MPR 0

Amorphous (T3, PHY) — Soft body, squeeze through gaps.
Chromatophore Reset (T2, PHY) — Innate color-change. Prereq: Chromatophore Layer slot ✓
Ink Cloud (T2, PHY) — Innate ink defense.
Keen Perception — Sight (T2, MNT) — Exceptional camera-type eyes.
Head (basic) — no Language cost possible without Advanced Biology.

True Dragon

Free Traits — Score 63, Pool 1, Starting XP 12, MPR 0

Thick Hide (T2, PHY) — Draconic scale armor.
Fang/Claw (T1, PHY) — Natural weapons.
Hollow Bones (T1, PHY) — Necessary for flight despite size.
Avian Wings (T3, PHY) — Innate flight capability.
Warm-Blooded (T1, PHY) — Endothermic. High metabolic rate.
Keen Perception — Sight (T2, MNT) — Dragon sight.
Keen Smell (T1, MNT) — Dragon scent.
Instinctual Signaling (T1, SOC) — Communication from birth.
Pool of 1 — almost entirely defined by morphotype.
Language, elemental breath, and supernatural traits come from Biology Rank XP investment.
Dragons grow up fast — Biology Ranks ARE their skill tree.

Elemental Form

Free Traits — Score 18, Pool 46, MPR 0

Elemental (T4, ARC) — Defines elemental nature. Required.
Incorporeal (T4, ARC) — Non-solid state.
Head (basic) — no Language cost. Sapience through Advanced Biology or [Supernatural] traits.
Largest pool in the system. Elemental Form is the purest blank-slate morphotype.
Fire elemental and water elemental are the same morphotype — different Biology Rank builds.

Rooted

Free Traits — Score 25, Pool 39, MPR 0

Thick Hide (T2, PHY) — Bark armor.
Dense Root System (T1, PHY) — Ground anchor. +1 PDR stationary.
Rapid Growth (T2, PHY) — HPR +2.
Widespread (T1, PHY) — Stealth in natural terrain.
Heartwood (T3, PHY) — HPR +2 stationary, +1 moving. Prereq: Rapid Growth ✓
No locomotion. Identity entirely in Biology Rank trait investment.

Ambulatory

Free Traits — Score 23, Pool 41, MPR 0

Dense Root System (T1, PHY) — Slow movement memory.
Rapid Growth (T2, PHY) — HPR +2.
Thick Hide (T2, PHY) — Bark armor.

Sylvan Form

Free Traits — Score 46, Pool 18, MPR 0

Rapid Growth (T2, PHY) — Flora resilience.
Mycorrhizal Symbiosis (T2, PHY) — MPR +1 in natural terrain.
Instinctual Signaling (T1, SOC) — Chemical and sound baseline.
Complex Flower Signal (T1, SOC) — Flora chemical communication.
Root-Neural Network (T1, MNT) — MPR recovery. Prereq: Complex Flower Signal ✓
Keen Perception — Sight (T2, MNT) — Dryad visual acuity.
Language is a pool purchase. A speaking Sylvan Form earns it through Biology Ranks.

Trent

Free Traits — Score 29, Pool 35, MPR 0

Thick Hide (T2, PHY) — Ancient bark.
Dense Root System (T1, PHY) — Ground anchor.
Rapid Growth (T2, PHY) — HPR +2.
Heartwood (T3, PHY) — HPR +2 stationary. Prereq: Rapid Growth ✓
Instinctual Signaling (T1, SOC) — Trent communication baseline.
Language is a pool purchase — Trents earn sapient communication through biological maturity.

Biology Type

Biology Type is the taxonomic family within a kingdom — the lineage that shaped the creature's evolutionary history. Rank 1 is granted free. Ranks 2–5 are purchased at the **Stat Rank XP curve (R × R+1)**:

Rank	XP Cost	Total XP	Life Stage	XP Equivalent	Notes
1	0	0	Adolescence	Free	Granted to all creatures. Birth-to-adolescence biology.
2	2 XP	2	Teenager	2 XP	First learned behaviors becoming reliable.
3	6 XP	8	Adult	6 XP	Full physical and social expression.
4	12 XP	20	Venerable	12 XP	Deepening of adult expression. Wisdom over growth.
5	20 XP	40	Mastery	20 XP	Integration of body, mind, soul. Arcane unlocks.

Life Stage Arc & Pool Distribution

Rank	Stage	PHY %	MNT %	SOC %	ARC %	Notes
1	Adolescence	80%	0%	20%	0%	Body forming. Instincts, signaling, early sensory.
2	Teenager	50%	25%	25%	0%	First cognitive development. Language possible.
3	Adult	33%	33%	33%	0%	Full expression. Advanced sensory and defense.
4	Venerable	33%	33%	33%	0%	Depth of mastery. Exceptional regeneration.
5	Mastery	20%	20%	20%	40%	Arcane integration. Supernatural traits unlock.

Trait Rank Gates

Trait tiers are gated behind Biology Rank milestones:

- T1 traits: available from Rank 1
- T2 traits: available from Rank 1 (common developmental traits) or Rank 2 (complex)
- T3 traits: available from Rank 2–3
- T4 traits: available from Rank 3–4
- [Advanced] traits: Rank 3+ minimum, requires Advanced Biology or specific Affinity Skills
- [Supernatural] traits: Rank 3+ minimum unless granted by morphotype free traits

Unused pool TP at any rank: converts to starter XP at 6:1.

Adaptable trait: grants 1 XP per 4 TP of unspent pool instead.

Advanced Biology

Post-Awakening Transformation

Unlocks through Awakening — a threshold event, not gradual advancement.

Same XP curve as Biology Type ($R \times R+1$). Total to Rank 5: 40 XP.

REPLACE: Old trait access list closes, new opens. Purchased traits retained.

EXTEND: Both Biology Types active. Two trait access lists. Increased rank-up cost.

Which mode applies is defined per Advanced Biology Type.

Trait Points & Pools

Pool	Tag	Covers	Examples
Physical	[PHY]	Body, limbs, armor, locomotion, senses	Thick Hide, Regenerant, Wings, Fang/Claw
Mental	[MNT]	Cognition, instinct, perception, memory	Ki-Sight, Mimicry, Heat Vision, Sleep Architecture
Social	[SOC]	Communication, pack behavior, hierarchy, display	Tribal, Pack Coordination, Fearsome Displays, Language
Arcane	[ARC]	Innate magic, elemental attunement, divine touch	Attuned, Blessed, Elemental, Energy Absorbing

Tier	TP / XP equiv.	Power Level	Examples
1	1 TP / 0.25 XP	Minor adaptation	Fur, Hooves, Groundsense, Stealthy, Webbed
2	2 TP / 0.5 XP	Significant advantage	Thick Hide, Venomous, Regenerant, Vocalizer, Pounce
3	3 TP / 0.75 XP	Major capability	Language, Rapid Regen, Avian Wings, Ki-Sight
4	4 TP / 1 XP	Extraordinary power	Blessed, Elemental, Energy Absorbing, Planarian Reconstruction
★	8 TP / 2 XP	Stat Rank — [Creation] only	Reinforced, Accelerated, Integrated — ancestral gifts. One total.

Trait Tags

Tag	Meaning
[Universal]	Available to any kingdom and morphotype without restriction.
[Natural]	Grounded in realistic biology. Available in all settings by default.
[Supernatural]	Magical or metaphysical. GM/world may restrict. Required for Supernatural diets. Rank 3+ unless morphotype-granted.
[Exotic]	Sci-fi, alien, or setting-specific. Restricted to worlds that define them.
[Advanced]	Advanced Biology or specific Affinity Skills only. Rank 3+ minimum.
[Creation]	Can only be purchased at character creation.
[Fauna]	Animalia kingdom only.
[Flora]	Plantae kingdom only.
[Fungal]	Fungi kingdom only.
[Protist]	Protista kingdom only.
[Prokaryote]	Monera kingdom only.

Stat Trait Families

Stat Traits are ancestral gifts made manifest — evolutionary expressions that exceed what personal training alone achieves. All cost **8 TP**, are **[Creation] only**, and grant **+1 Stat Rank** plus additional effects that XP alone cannot purchase.

Critical Rules

ONE Stat Trait total — across all three families combined. This is the single most defining biological statement about your lineage. Choose carefully.

Max pool bonuses scale with Biology Rank (+1 per rank). At Rank 5 the gift has fully expressed.

2 XP on a raw Stat Rank = +1 Rank only.

8 TP on a Stat Trait = +1 Rank + scaling Max pool + Regen or Unique bonus.

Stat Traits always feel better than raw XP on stats. This is intentional.

ASCENSION PATH: If a creature reaches Stat Rank 5 through XP before gaining a Stat Trait, the trait may be gained through a threshold event (Awakening, divine encounter, etc.).

In this case the Stat Rank grant pushes beyond the normal ceiling — recorded as Rank 5+.

This is one path to becoming a demi-god. It cannot be purchased. It must be lived.

BDY Traits — PHY Pool | Prereq: Torso/Back slot

Trait	+Stat / Max Pool	Regen	Unique Bonus
Reinforced	+1 BDY / Max HP +1/Rank	—	+1 PDR permanently.
Vitalized	+1 BDY / Max HP +1/Rank	HPR +1	Pure completeness — the most comprehensive BDY expression.
Ironwilled	+1 BDY / Max SP +1/Rank	—	Cannot be reduced below 1 HP more than once per round.
Immovable	+1 BDY / Max HP +1/Rank	—	Immune to involuntary movement from smaller creatures.

SPT Traits — PHY/SOC Pool | PHY prereq: Legs or Wings slot | SOC prereq: Instinctual Signaling

Trait	Pool	+Stat / Max Pool	Regen	Unique Bonus
Accelerated	PHY	+1 SPT / Max SP +1/Rank	—	+1 AP at the start of each combat.
Calibrated	PHY	+1 SPT / Max SP +1/Rank	SPR +1	Pure reflex completeness.
Sensitized	SOC	+1 SPT / Max SP +1/Rank	—	Cannot be surprised. Always acts in surprise rounds.
Reactive	PHY	+1 SPT / No pool increase	SPR +2	+1 DT at start of each round. Trades capacity for pure reflex.

MND Traits — MNT/SOC Pool | Prereq: Head/Neck slot (not basic)

Trait	Pool	+Stat / Max Pool	Regen	Unique Bonus
Integrated	MNT	+1 MND / Max MP +1/Rank	—	+1 die on all MND checks (ungated). MND is hardest to build around.
Expanded	MNT	+1 MND / Max MP +1/Rank	MPR +1	Pure cognitive completeness.
Developed	SOC	+1 MND / No pool increase	MPR +2	+1 to all skill checks. The generalist mind — breadth over depth.
Structured	MNT	+1 MND / Max MP +1/Rank	—	Once per scene, reroll any MND check and take the better result.

Trait-Granted Skills & Biological Integration

Some traits grant a skill at Rank 1 as part of their effect. These represent behaviors practiced since adolescence — not learned intellectually, but lived physically.

Biological Integration Rule

Trait-granted skills begin at Rank 1 — already integrated into the creature's routine.

In their biological context: gain a bonus die AND cannot critically fail.

Biological context = the specific sensory, physical, or instinctual domain the trait operates in.

Defined at the time the trait is taken. Cannot be broader than the trait's mechanical description.

Example: Keen Smell grants Tracking. Context = scent-based detection only.

In context: bonus die + no critical fail.

Outside context (visual tracking): standard rolls, standard fail range.

Trait Trees

Traits are organized into trees with prerequisites, Biology Rank gates, and incompatibilities. A trait cannot be purchased unless all prerequisites are met and the creature's Biology Rank equals or exceeds the gate. Trees may be linear (must follow the chain) or branching (multiple valid paths to the same tier). Both structures exist based on biological logic.

Tree Reading Guide

Prereq: Traits that must be owned before this trait can be purchased.

Rank: Minimum Biology Rank required to purchase.

Incompatible: Traits that cannot coexist — purchasing one closes the other.

Pool: Which TP pool this trait draws from at purchase.

Free traits on the morphotype count as meeting prerequisites for pool purchases.

Communication & Language Tree

Trait	T	Pool	Rank	Tags	Effect	Incompatible With
Instinctual Signaling	1	SOC	1	[Universal]	Communicate emotion and intent through sound/gesture. Understood by same species. No language cost.	—
Vocalizer	2	SOC	1	[Fauna]	Prereq: Instinctual Signaling. Produce learned sounds and mimic calls. Physical apparatus for language. Grants Mimicry Rank 1 [context: sound]. 0 MPR cost.	—
Language	3	MNT	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Vocalizer. Full symbolic communication. One language at creation. Gates all language-dependent social skills. -1 MPR.	—
Multilingual	2	MNT	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Language. One additional language per purchase. Repeatable. 0 MPR.	—
Written Language	2	MNT	3	[Universal]	Prereq: Language. Encode and decode symbolic writing. 0 MPR.	—
Gestural Language	2	SOC	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Instinctual Signaling. Full language through body, hands, or color. Silent. Counts as Language for SOC skill gating. 0 MPR.	—
Complex Flower Signal	1	SOC	1	[Flora]	Prereq: Instinctual Signaling. Chemical signal communication. Telepathic Link with Flora within Bio Rank × 10 ft.	—
Composite Signal	2	SOC	2	[Flora]	Prereq: Complex Flower Signal. +2 Persuasion with Flora and creatures with Keen Smell or Capitula Sensing.	—
Mycorrhizal Network	3	SOC	3	[Flora][Fungal]	Prereq: Composite Signal OR Mycorrhizal Symbiosis. Silent communication with Flora/Fungal allies within Bio Rank × 30 ft.	—

Vision Tree

Trait	T	Po ol	R a n k	Tags	Effect	Incompatible With
Low-Light Vision	1	MN T	1	[Universal]	See in very dim light.	White Eyes
Night Vision	1	MN T	1	[Universal]	Prereq: Low-Light Vision. Enhanced low-light clarity.	White Eyes
Dark Vision	2	MN T	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Night Vision. See greyscale in total darkness up to 6 tiles.	White Eyes
White Eyes	2	MN T	3	[Universal]	Prereq: Dark Vision. Total darkness sight. Blinded by bright light. Terminal — closes entire light-adaptive branch.	Low-Light Vision, Night Vision, Keen Perception Sight, Heat Vision
Wide-Angle Vision	1	MN T	1	[Universal]	Standalone. Increased field of view. Prevents flanking.	—
Keen Perception — Sight	2	MN T	1	[Universal]	Standalone. Halve crit success range; double crit fail range on sight checks.	White Eyes
Heat Vision	2	MN T	2	[Fauna]	Prereq: Keen Perception — Sight. See heat signatures. ×2 Notice vs Warm-blooded.	White Eyes

Sensory Trees

Trait	T	Po ol	R a n k	Tags	Effect	Incompatible With
Keen Smell	1	MN T	1	[Fauna]	Standalone. +4 to detect by scent. Grants Tracking Rank 1 [context: scent].	—
Echolocation	2	MN T	1	[Fauna]	Standalone. Super-hearing with directional awareness. ×2 Notice to hearing. Grants Tracking Rank 1 [context: sound].	—
Groundsense	1	MN T	1	[Universal]	Standalone. Detect vibrations through ground. ×2 Notice when grounded. Grants Tracking Rank 1 [context: vibration].	—
Lateral Line	2	MN T	2	[Fauna]	Prereq: Groundsense OR Amphibious. ×2 Notice vs moving targets in water.	—
Electroreceptive Clarity	2	MN T	2	[Natural][Fauna]	Prereq: Lateral Line. MPR +1 near electromagnetic sources or water.	—
Asymmetric Perception	1	MN T	1	[Flora]	Standalone. +2 Notice vs movement on one designated side.	—
Capitula Sensing	2	MN T	1	[Flora]	Standalone. ×2 Notice for airborne particles — pollen, spores, chemical signals.	—
Monocot Awareness	1	MN T	1	[Flora]	Standalone. Aware of underground water within Bio Rank × 20 ft.	—

Night-Blooming Sense	2	MNT	2	[Flora]	Prereq: Low-Light Vision. Grants Low-Light Vision if not owned. +2 MNT checks at night.	—
Ki-Sight	3	MNT	3	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Any two sensory traits. See energies, auras, and magical flows.	—
Wind Pollination Sense	1	MNT	1	[Flora]	Standalone. +2 ranged accuracy in wind. Never suffer wind accuracy penalties.	—

HP Regen Tree

Trait	T	Pool	Rank	Tags	Effect	Incompatible With
Regenerant	2	PHY	1	[Universal]	Standalone baseline. HPR +1.	Vampire Feeding
Rapid Regen	3	PHY	2	[Natural][Fauna]	Prereq: Regenerant. HPR +2. Regrow lost appendages over Bio Rank days.	—
Troll Mending	3	PHY	3	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Rapid Regen. HPR +2. Suppressed 1 round after Fire or Acid damage.	—
Planarian Reconstruction	4	PHY	4	[Natural][Advanced]	Prereq: Rapid Regen. HPR +3. Reconstruct from 0 HP over 1 hour if not destroyed.	—
Phoenix Surge	4	PHY	4	[Supernatural][Advanced]	Prereq: Rapid Regen OR Troll Mending. HPR +2. Once/long rest recover Bio Rank HP at 0.	Cryptobiosis, Golem Stillness
Heartwood	3	PHY	2	[Natural][Flora]	Prereq: Rapid Growth. HPR +2 stationary, HPR +1 moving.	Rapid Regen
Hydra Regrowth	4	PHY	4	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Rapid Regen. Taking 10+ damage in one hit: HPR +3 for 2 rounds.	—
Vampire Feeding	3	PHY	3	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Fang/Claw OR Venomous. After dealing HP damage: HPR +2 until end of next round.	Regenerant
Cryptobiosis	3	PHY	2	[Natural]	Prereq: Regenerant OR Hibernate Recovery. HPR doubles when unconscious or fully stationary 1 round.	Warm-Blooded, Phoenix Surge, Golem Stillness
Golem Stillness	2	PHY	2	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Thick Hide. HPR +3 when completely stationary for 1 full round.	Phoenix Surge, Cryptobiosis, Rapid Regen
Hibernate Recovery	2	PHY	1	[Natural][Fauna]	Prereq: Cold Blooded OR Warm-Blooded. HPR ×3 while Hibernating. Cannot act but aware.	Meditative Rest, Sleep Architecture

SP Regen Tree

Trait	T	Pool	Rank	Tags	Effect	Incompatible With
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Quickened Recovery	2	PH Y	1	[Universal]	Standalone baseline. SPR +1.	—
Anaerobic Efficiency	2	PH Y	2	[Natural][Fau na]	Prereq: Quickened Recovery. SPR +1. No SP penalty in low-oxygen environments.	Warm-Blooded
Dragonscale Metabolism	3	PH Y	3	[Natural][Fau na]	Prereq: Quickened Recovery + Thick Hide OR Exoskeleton. SPR +1 per 2 Bio Ranks.	—
Chromatophore Reset	2	PH Y	2	[Natural][Fau na]	Prereq: Quickened Recovery + Chromatophore Layer slot. SPR +1. Recover 1 SP after Camouflage/Stealthy.	—
Selkie Attunement	2	PH Y	2	[Natural][Sup ernatural]	Prereq: Amphibious. SPR +2 within 10 ft of natural water.	Anaerobic Efficiency
Symbiote Sharing	3	PH Y	3	[Exotic]	Prereq: Symbiote Port slot. SPR +1. Ally within 5 ft may use your SPR once/round.	—

MP Regen Tree

Trait	T	Pool	Rank	Tags	Effect	Incompatible With
Glial Density	1	MN T	1	[Natural][Univ ersal]	Standalone. MPR +1. Pure neural support efficiency. No drawback.	—
Myelin Efficiency	2	MN T	2	[Natural][Fau na]	Prereq: Glial Density. MPR +1. +1 die on first MND check each combat.	—
Psion Cycling	3	MN T	3	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Myelin Efficiency. MPR +2. Each MP spent returns 1 MPR next round.	—
Phylactery Tether	4	MN T	4	[Advanced][S upernatural]	Prereq: Psion Cycling. MPR +3. If slain, reform at phylactery after Bio Rank hours.	—
Gut-Brain Axis	1	MN T	1	[Natural][Fau na]	Prereq: Language. MPR +1. Enteric nervous system cognitive recovery pathway.	Head (basic)
Root-Neural Network	1	MN T	1	[Natural][Flor a]	Prereq: Language OR Complex Flower Signal. MPR +1. Distributed root cognitive reset.	—
Mycelial Cognition	1	MN T	1	[Natural][Fun gal]	Prereq: Language OR Mycorrhizal Network. MPR +1. Network-wide signal cognitive recovery.	—
Kami Renewal	3	MN T	3	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Glial Density OR Gut-Brain Axis. MPR +2 in natural/sacred spaces. MPR +0 urban.	—
Sleep Architecture	2	MN T	1	[Natural][Fau na]	Standalone. MPR +2. Requires 6–8 hours sleep per long rest. If sleep-deprived: MPR –1 until full cycle.	Meditative Rest, Cold Blooded, Cryptobiosis, Hibernate Recovery
Meditative Rest	2	MN T	2	[Natural][Sup ernatural]	Prereq: Language. MPR +1. 4-hour conscious rest replaces sleep. Cannot be surprised during meditation. Immune to sleep effects.	Sleep Architecture, Hibernate Recovery

Combined Regen

Trait	T	Pool	Rank	Tags	Effect	Incompatible With
Whole-Body Recovery	3	PHY	3	[Universal]	Prereq: Any two of Regenerant, Quickened Recovery, Glial Density. HPR +1, SPR +1, MPR +1. Undeath interaction: SPR +1 converts to HPR +1 for Undead creatures.	—
Elemental Reformation	4	PHY	4	[Advanced][Exotic]	Prereq: Whole-Body Recovery + Elemental trait. HPR +2, SPR +2, MPR +2 in native elemental environment.	—

Undeath Tree

Undeath is a five-tier trait family representing the full spectrum of animated death — from crude reanimation to transcendent immortality. Each tier is a prerequisite for the next. The pool shifts from PHY in early tiers through PHY/ARC in the middle to pure ARC at the apex, reflecting the journey from physical death into something genuinely new.

The Universal Undeath Rule

Applies identically across all five tiers:

- No Max SP. No SPR. All SP costs become HP costs at 1:1.
- All SP restores become HP restores at 1:1.
- SPR on character sheet converts to HPR 1:1.
- Wings: lose Max SP creation cost, instead apply −1 Max HP.
- Diet bonuses that would grant Max SP instead grant Max HP.

BORN UNDEAD: Take Undeath I at creation from PHY pool. Character has never had SP.

Build assumes HP as sole active resource from the ground up.

INFLICTED UNDEATH: When a living creature gains Undeath through transformation:

- Current Max SP converts to Max HP 1:1. SPR converts to HPR 1:1.
- Tier gained is determined by the inflicting event's nature and power.
- Creatures may advance through higher tiers through play, dark tutoring, or narrative threshold events.

Tier	T	Pool	Rank	Tags	Additional Effects	MPR Cost
I — Animate Dead <i>Dhampir · fresh ghoul · newly risen</i>	3	PHY	2+	[Supernatural]	Prereq: none. Core rule applies (above). Reflexes and locomotion only. Biological MPR sources fully suppressed — gut-brain axis dormant, sleep architecture offline. Immune to biological needs (hunger, air, water) but not their mechanical equivalents in combat.	MPR 0. Body simply is not done dying. No magical maintenance required yet.

II — Sustained Form <i>Young vampire · wight · intelligent undead</i>	3	PHY	3 +	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Undeath I. Begins maintaining select biological systems through necromantic intention: basic circulation analog, sensory processing, decomposition arrest. Mind sharpens as maintenance begins. Gains access to the Undead trait sub-tree. Vampire Feeding no longer requires Fang/Claw prereq.	MPR -1. First magical overhead. The will to persist costs something.
III — Preserved Vessel <i>Vampire lord · mummy · elder wight</i>	4	PHY / ARC	3 +	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Undeath II. Full organ system maintenance through deliberate magical intention. Can pass as living under casual inspection — warmth, breath, pulse all simulated. Biological MPR sources partially restored (magic substitutes biological pathways). +2 PDR from structural optimization of preserved tissue.	MPR -2. Maintaining the living mask is exhausting. Partially offsets through restored biological MPR.
IV — Awakened Undeath <i>Death knight · revenant · purpose-bound</i>	4	PHY / ARC	4 +	[Supernatural][Advanced]	Prereq: Undeath III. The creature stops simulating life and develops genuine undead systems — cold fire instead of warm blood, bone resonance instead of heartbeat, necrotic efficiency instead of metabolism. Biological MPR sources fully restored through undead substitution. Gains Undead Affinity (Necrotic, Cold, or Shadow) at Rank 1 free. +1 die on all saves vs turning, banishment, and holy effects. Cannot pass as living — the nature is fully and permanently expressed.	MPR -2. Acceptance costs the same as denial. Biological MPR fully restored — the plateau is earned.
V — Transcendent Undeath <i>Lich · ancient vampire · death apotheosis</i>	4	ARC	4 +	[Supernatural][Advanced]	Prereq: Undeath IV + Phylactery Tether. Consciousness fully divorced from biological necessity. The body is a vessel maintained entirely by will and arcane architecture. Phylactery Tether integrated at no additional trait cost. Immune to biological conditions: disease, poison, aging, suffocation. +1 die on all ARC checks. +4 PDR total (cumulative with Tier III). This is the pinnacle. There is no higher form of undeath.	MPR -3. The price of immortality. Every point is worth it.

Undeath Progression at a Glance

Tier I — T3 PHY, Rank 2+. MPR 0. Reflexes only. Born undead baseline.
 Tier II — T3 PHY, Rank 3+. MPR -1. First maintenance. Mind sharpens.
 Tier III — T4 PHY/ARC, Rank 3+. MPR -2. Full maintenance. Can pass as living.
 Tier IV — T4 PHY/ARC, Rank 4+. MPR -2. Acceptance. Undead systems replace living ones.
 Tier V — T4 ARC, Rank 4+. MPR -3. Transcendence. Phylactery integrated. Truly immortal.

The MPR plateau between Tier III and IV is intentional:

Maintaining the living mask costs exactly as much as accepting what you are.

The difference is not cost — it is choice.

Defensive Trees

Trait	T	Po ol	R a n k	Tags	Effect	Incompatible With
Fur	1	PH Y	1	[Fauna]	Standalone. +2 Cold DR. +1 Bashing Defense.	Exoskeleton, Mucous Coat
Exoskeleton	2	PH Y	1	[Fauna]	Standalone. ¼ Slashing, ½ Piercing, ×2 Bashing.	Fur, Mucous Coat, Thick Hide (natural path)
Mucous Coat	1	PH Y	1	[Fauna]	Standalone. +1 DR vs Slashing, -1 DR vs Cold. Path to Amphibious.	Fur, Exoskeleton, Spiked Defense, Bristles
Thick Hide	2	PH Y	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Fur OR Exoskeleton OR Dense Root System. ¼ Bashing, ½ Slashing, ×2 Piercing.	—
Spiked Defense	2	PH Y	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Thick Hide OR Bristles. Melee attackers take 2 piercing damage on hit.	Mucous Coat
Bristles / Thorny Stems	2	PH Y	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Thick Hide OR Dense Root System. Melee attackers take 2 piercing damage on hit.	Mucous Coat, Soft Stems
Dense Root System	1	PH Y	1	[Flora]	Standalone. +1 PDR stationary. +1 SP to reposition.	Soft Stems
Bulbous Roots	1	PH Y	1	[Flora]	Prereq: Dense Root System. Max HP +2. Cannot be uprooted without BDY check vs Bio Rank.	Hollow Stems, Epiphytic Growth
Soft Stems	1	PH Y	1	[Flora]	Standalone. ½ Bashing. ×2 Slashing. Squeeze through gaps 1 size smaller.	Dense Root System, Bristles, Bulbous Roots
Alkaloid Compounds	2	PH Y	2	[Flora]	Prereq: Pungent Oils OR Herbaceous. Melee attackers must save vs Poison 1. Grants Poison Resist.	—
Warm-Blooded	1	PH Y	1	[Fauna]	Standalone. +1 HPR when Warm. +1 SPR when Cool. -1 HP/turn when Hot or Cold.	Cold Blooded, Anaerobic Efficiency, Cryptobiosis
Cold Blooded	1	PH Y	1	[Fauna]	Standalone. +1 SPR when Warm. +1 HPR when Cool. -1 HP/turn when Hot or Cold.	Warm-Blooded, Sleep Architecture, Anaerobic Efficiency
Heat Resist	2	PH Y	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Warm-Blooded OR Cold Blooded. +2 DR and saves vs Fire.	—
Frost Tolerant	1	PH Y	1	[Universal]	Prereq: Warm-Blooded OR Fur. +2 Cold DR. No SP penalty in cold environments.	—
Poison Resist	2	PH Y	2	[Universal]	Standalone. Rank 2 minimum. +2 DR and saves vs Poison.	—
Amorphous	3	PH Y	2	[Universal]	Standalone. ¼ Piercing, ½ Bashing, ×2 Slashing.	Exoskeleton, Thick Hide

Locomotion Trees

Trait	T	Po ol	R a n k	Tags	Effect	Incompatible With
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Hollow Bones	1	PH Y	1	[Fauna]	Standalone. +5 SPD, +2 vs Slashing, -2 vs Bashing, -10% weight.	Dense Bones
Dense Bones	1	PH Y	1	[Fauna]	Standalone. -5 SPD, +2 vs Bashing, -2 vs Slashing, +10% weight.	Hollow Bones, Digitigrade
Digitigrade	1	PH Y	1	[Fauna]	Prereq: Hollow Bones. +5 SPD, +1 tile jump. Incompatible: Dense Bones.	Dense Bones, Webbed
Heavy-Set	1	PH Y	1	[Fauna]	Prereq: Dense Bones. Gain Quicken after moving. Lose Quicken on non-move action.	—
Hooves	1	PH Y	1	[Fauna]	Standalone. +1 SPD on hard terrain. Path to Endurance Runner.	Webbed, Forelimb Claws as feet
Endurance Runner	1	PH Y	1	[Fauna]	Prereq: Hooves OR Digitigrade OR bipedal anatomy. Reduce chained Move SP surcharge by 1 once/round.	—
Webbed	1	PH Y	1	[Natural][Fauna]	Standalone. +1 swim SPD. Path to Amphibious.	Digitigrade, Hooves
Amphibious	2	PH Y	1	[Universal]	Prereq: Webbed OR Gill Slits slot OR Mucous Coat. Equal swim and walk speed.	—
Burrower	2	PH Y	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Dense Bones OR Thick Hide. Move through soft ground at normal speed.	—
Avian Wings	3	PH Y	2	[Fauna]	Prereq: Wings slot + (Hollow Bones OR Helium Gas Bladder). +1 Soar checks. Double Slashing on Wing called shots.	Chiropteran Wings, Insectile Wings
Chiropteran Wings	3	PH Y	2	[Fauna]	Prereq: Wings slot. +1 Maneuver checks. Cannot Soar at Tier 3+ altitude.	Avian Wings, Insectile Wings
Insectile Wings	2	PH Y	1	[Fauna]	Prereq: Wings slot. +1 Hover checks. Cannot Glide. +50% SP on Takeoff.	Avian Wings, Chiropteran Wings
Aerodynamic	2	PH Y	2	[Fauna]	Prereq: Any wing trait. Multiple move actions don't increase SP cost.	—
Aerokinetic Membranes	3	PH Y	3	[Fauna]	Prereq: Aerodynamic. Gain Glider + 10 ft Glide SPD. Maneuver without AP cost once/round.	—
Gas Bladder	2	PH Y	2	[Fauna]	Prereq: Hollow Bones. -25% weight, +1 Takeoff. Passive buoyancy assists sustained flight. Roll CON at Tier 4 Altitude or disoriented. Vulnerability: called shot to torso deflates bladder — lose buoyancy benefit until rest.	Dense Bones, Helium Gas Bladder
Helium Gas Bladder	2	PH Y	2	[Fauna]	Prereq: Wings slot + (Chemosynthetic OR Nitrogen-Fixing diet). Internal helium-producing organ. -25% effective weight for flight purposes. Dense bones remain intact — no Hollow Bones required. Enables Avian Wings without Hollow Bones. Vulnerability: called shot puncture causes rapid deflation — lose all flight buoyancy, -10 SPD until healed. No SPD bonus (bones stay dense).	Hollow Bones, Gas Bladder
Ethereal Drift	3	PH Y	3	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Any movement trait OR Incorporeal. Hover/descend without gravity effects. Cannot ascend without flight skill.	Avian Wings, Chiropteran Wings, Insectile Wings

Levitation Core	3	PH Y	3	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Ethereal Drift OR Psionic Propulsion. Hover: +5 SPD, +1 Hover. Cannot Soar/Ascend above ½ SPD.	—
Psionic Propulsion	4	PH Y	4	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Levitation Core OR Integrated (Stat Trait). Hover at will. +2 all Flight checks, +1 SP/round.	—
Climbing Vines	2	PH Y	2	[Flora]	Prereq: Dense Root System. Climb at full speed. Passive grapple of structures if stationary.	—
Epiphytic Growth	2	PH Y	2	[Flora]	Prereq: Climbing Vines. Attach and grow on surfaces. No soil required.	Bulbous Roots
Vertical Growth	1	PH Y	1	[Flora]	Prereq: Rapid Growth. +1 tile reach. Scales with Bio Rank.	—
Fast Spreading	1	PH Y	2	[Flora]	Prereq: Vertical Growth. Recover 1 HP/round stationary in natural terrain.	—
Rapid Lifecycle	2	PH Y	3	[Flora]	Prereq: Dense Root System. Once/long rest shed and regrow to remove one negative condition. Costs 4 HP.	—

Offensive Trees

Trait	T	Po ol	R a n k	Tags	Effect	Incompatible With
Fang/Claw	1	PH Y	1	[Fauna]	Standalone. Fang/Claw piercing attacks ignore 2 PDR.	—
Venomous	2	PH Y	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Fang/Claw OR Proboscis slot. Inflicts Poison through attacks or contact.	—
Acid Spit	2	PH Y	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Venom Gland slot OR Proboscis slot. SPT attack: Acid Damage + Blind +1 stack.	—
Antlers	2	PH Y	1	[Fauna]	Prereq: Natural Weapons slot. Bash/shove weapon. Intimidate bonus = Bio Rank.	Fang/Claw as primary
Constrict	2	PH Y	2	[Fauna]	Prereq: Serpentine Tail OR Tentacles slot. While grappling: Squeeze for BDY bash once/turn.	—
Stealthy	1	PH Y	1	[Universal]	Standalone. +4 to Stealth checks.	—
Ambusher	1	SO C	1	[Universal]	Prereq: Stealthy. +2 damage when attacking from stealth.	—
Pounce	2	PH Y	2	[Fauna]	Prereq: Ambusher. Moved ≥2 tiles toward flanked/unaware target: +1 damage die on first melee attack.	—
Predator's Mark	2	SO C	2	[Fauna]	Prereq: Pounce. Mark a target. +2 to attack it.	—
Explosive Escape	2	PH Y	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Ink Cloud OR Spore Cloud OR Acid Spit. Create flash/sound/gas to escape.	—

Ink Cloud	2	PH Y	2	[Fauna]	Prereq: Chromatophore Layer slot OR Molluscoid morphotype. 1 AP, 1 SP: Obscuring 2 tiles.	—
Spore Cloud	2	PH Y	2	[Fungal]	Prereq: Fungal kingdom. 1 AP: 1 tile Obscuring + Poison 1 stack on entry.	—
Pungent Oils	2	PH Y	2	[Flora]	Standalone. Aura 1 tile: save or -1 MND checks. Grants Poison Resist.	—
Toxic Fruit	2	SO C	3	[Flora]	Prereq: Edible Fruits + Alkaloid Compounds. Produce toxic fruit trap. Save vs Poison 2.	Fleshy Fruits
Cloning Spawn	4	PH Y	4	[Supernatural]	Standalone. 3 AP, lose R HP: create clone with R HP and 2 AP. One at a time.	—

Social Trees

Trait	T	Pol	Rank	Tags	Effect	Incompatible With
Tribal	1	SO C	1	[Universal]	Standalone. +2 flanking bonus with allies.	—
Pack Coordination	2	SO C	2	[Fauna]	Prereq: Tribal. +1 attack when ally within 10 ft of target.	—
Leader	2	SO C	3	[Universal]	Prereq: Pack Coordination OR Disciplined. +2 on Leader skills.	Bloodlust
Telepathic Link	3	MN T	3	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Leader OR Language. Silent communication with allies and tamed beasts.	—
Fearsome Displays	2	SO C	1	[Universal]	Standalone. Intimidate enemies, -2 enemy defense.	—
Territorial	1	SO C	1	[Universal]	Standalone. +2 attack when defending home terrain.	—
Bloodlust	2	SO C	2	[Fauna]	Prereq: Fearsome Displays. +1 melee attacks. -2 SPT and MND Social skills.	Cultured, Leader
Cultured	2	SO C	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Instinctual Signaling + Language OR Gestural Language. +2 to SPT and MND Social Skills.	Bloodlust
Disciplined	2	SO C	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Tool User OR Leader. +1 to Physical Ranged and Affinity attacks.	—
Tool User	1	SO C	1	[Universal]	Standalone. +2 to tool-related checks.	—
Memory Recall	1	MN T	1	[Universal]	Standalone. +2 to remembering obscure knowledge.	—
Mimicry	2	MN T	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Memory Recall. Copy a sound, movement, or ability used last round with +1 AP cost.	—
Versatile Adaptation	2	MN T	3	[Universal]	Prereq: Mimicry + Language. Once/long rest gain temporary Rank 1 proficiency for 1 hour.	—
Feign Death	1	MN T	1	[Universal]	Prereq: Stealthy. SPT vs MND to convincingly feign death.	—

Skilled	2	MN T	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Memory Recall. Gain one skill at Rank 1 with +1 on checks or attacks.	—
Edible Fruits	1	SO C	2	[Flora]	Standalone. Produce edible fruit once/rest. Allies recover 2 SP.	—
Fleshy Fruits	2	SO C	3	[Flora]	Prereq: Edible Fruits. Allies recover 2 HP and 2 SP.	Toxic Fruit
Vivid Blooms	1	SO C	1	[Flora]	Standalone. +2 Persuasion/Distracton when blooming.	—

Miscellaneous Traits

Trait	T	Tags	Effect
Adaptable	2	[Universal][Creati on]	Grants 1 XP per 4 TP of unspent pool. Biological plasticity — converts potential directly to experience at the natural rate.
Attuned	4	[Universal][Super natural]	Prereq: Rank 3. Tier 1 Arcane Affinity at Rank 1. 2 DR vs Affinity Type.
Blessed	4	[Universal][Super natural]	Prereq: Rank 3. Tier 1 Emotional Affinity at Rank 1. 2 DR vs Affinity Type.
Elemental	4	[Universal][Super natural]	Prereq: Rank 3. Tier 1 Elemental Affinity at Rank 1. 2 DR vs Affinity Type.
Energy Absorbing	4	[Universal][Super natural]	Prereq: Attuned OR Elemental OR Blessed. DR 2 to Affinity. Heal for damage prevented.
Immortal	4	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Rank 4. Revives in a random or chosen location when slain.
Incorporeal	4	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Rank 3. Immune to physical damage; weak to magic.
Parasitic (trait)	2	[Universal]	Prereq: Venomous OR Proboscis slot. Hitting infected enemies restores 1 HP, SP, and MP.

Incompatibility Master List

Purchasing any trait on the left closes access to all traits listed on the right, and vice versa.

Trait	Incompatible With
Cold Blooded	Warm-Blooded, Sleep Architecture, Anaerobic Efficiency
Warm-Blooded	Cold Blooded, Anaerobic Efficiency, Cryptobiosis
Hollow Bones	Dense Bones, Helium Gas Bladder
Helium Gas Bladder	Hollow Bones, Gas Bladder
Dense Bones	Hollow Bones, Digitigrade
Digitigrade	Dense Bones, Webbed
Webbed	Digitigrade, Hooves
Hooves	Webbed
Fur	Exoskeleton, Mucous Coat
Exoskeleton	Fur, Mucous Coat
Mucous Coat	Fur, Exoskeleton, Spiked Defense, Bristles
Amorphous	Exoskeleton, Thick Hide
White Eyes	Low-Light Vision, Night Vision, Keen Perception Sight, Heat Vision
Sleep Architecture	Meditative Rest, Cold Blooded, Cryptobiosis, Hibernate Recovery
Meditative Rest	Sleep Architecture, Hibernate Recovery
Cryptobiosis	Warm-Blooded, Phoenix Surge, Golem Stillness
Golem Stillness	Phoenix Surge, Cryptobiosis, Rapid Regen
Phoenix Surge	Cryptobiosis, Golem Stillness
Avian Wings	Chiropteran Wings, Insectile Wings
Chiropteran Wings	Avian Wings, Insectile Wings
Insectile Wings	Avian Wings, Chiropteran Wings
Ethereal Drift	Avian Wings, Chiropteran Wings, Insectile Wings
Bloodlust	Cultured, Leader
Fleshy Fruits	Toxic Fruit
Toxic Fruit	Fleshy Fruits
Bulbous Roots	Epiphytic Growth, Hollow Stems
Soft Stems	Dense Root System, Bristles, Bulbous Roots
Vampire Feeding	Regenerant
Heartwood	Rapid Regen
Stat Traits	Only ONE Stat Trait total across all three families (BDY/SPT/MND)
Gut-Brain Axis	Head (basic) morphology
Anaerobic Efficiency	Selkie Attunement
Undeath (any tier)	Sleep Architecture, Cryptobiosis, Warm-Blooded, Hibernate Recovery (biological needs suspended)
Antlers	Fang/Claw as primary natural weapon

Trait Compendium — Quick Reference

Full tree details including prerequisites, rank gates, and incompatibilities are in the Trait Trees section above. This table provides at-a-glance reference for all traits.

Trait	T	Tags	Effect
Acid Spit	2	[Universal]	SPT attack: Acid Damage + Blind +1 stack on hit.
Adaptable	2	[Universal][Creation]	Grants 1 XP per 4 TP unspent pool.
Aerodynamic	2	[Fauna]	Multiple move actions don't increase SP cost.
Aerokinetic Membranes	3	[Fauna]	Gain Glider + 10 ft Glide SPD. Maneuver free once/round.
Alkaloid Compounds	2	[Flora]	Attackers save vs Poison 1. Grants Poison Resist.
Amorphous	3	[Universal]	¼ Piercing, ½ Bashing, ×2 Slashing.
Ambusher	1	[Universal]	+2 damage when attacking from stealth.
Amphibious	2	[Universal]	Equal swim and walk speed.
Antlers	2	[Fauna]	Bash/shove weapon. Intimidate bonus = Bio Rank.
Asymmetric Perception	1	[Flora]	+2 Notice vs movement on designated side.
Attuned	4	[Supernatural]	Tier 1 Arcane Affinity. 2 DR vs Affinity Type.
Avian Wings	3	[Fauna]	+1 Soar checks. Double Slashing on wing called shots.
Blessed	4	[Supernatural]	Tier 1 Emotional Affinity. 2 DR vs Affinity Type.
Bloodlust	2	[Fauna]	+1 melee attacks. -2 SPT and MND Social skills.
Bristles / Thorny Stems	2	[Universal]	Melee attackers take 2 piercing damage on hit.
Bulbous Roots	1	[Flora]	Max HP +2. Cannot be uprooted without BDY check.
Burrower	2	[Universal]	Move through soft ground at normal speed.
Capitula Sensing	2	[Flora]	×2 Notice for airborne particles.
Chiropteran Wings	3	[Fauna]	+1 Maneuver checks. Cannot Soar at Tier 3+ altitude.
Chromatophore Reset	2	[Natural][Fauna]	SPR +1. Recover 1 SP after Camouflage/Stealthy.
Climbing Vines	2	[Flora]	Climb at full speed. Passive structural grapple.
Cloning Spawn	4	[Supernatural]	Create clone with R HP. One at a time.
Cold Blooded	1	[Fauna]	+1 SPR when Warm. +1 HPR when Cool.
Complex Flower Signal	1	[Flora]	Chemical signals. Telepathic Link with nearby Flora.
Composite Signal	2	[Flora]	+2 Persuasion with Flora and scent-capable creatures.
Constrict	2	[Fauna]	While grappling: BDY bash once/turn.
Cryptobiosis	3	[Natural]	HPR doubles when unconscious or fully stationary.

Cultured	2	[Universal]	+2 to SPT and MND Social Skills.
Dark Vision	2	[Universal]	See greyscale in total darkness up to 6 tiles.
Dense Bones	1	[Fauna]	−5 SPD, +2 vs Bashing, +10% weight.
Dense Root System	1	[Flora]	+1 PDR stationary. +1 SP to reposition.
Digitigrade	1	[Fauna]	+5 SPD, +1 tile jump.
Disciplined	2	[Universal]	+1 Physical Ranged and Affinity attacks.
Dragonscale Metabolism	3	[Natural][Fauna]	SPR +1 per 2 Bio Ranks.
Echolocation	2	[Fauna]	×2 Notice hearing. Grants Tracking [context: sound].
Edible Fruits	1	[Flora]	Produce fruit/rest. Allies recover 2 SP.
Electroreceptive Clarity	2	[Natural][Fauna]	MPR +1 near EM sources or water.
Elemental	4	[Supernatural]	Tier 1 Elemental Affinity. 2 DR vs Affinity Type.
Elemental Reformation	4	[Advanced][Exotic]	HPR+2, SPR+2, MPR+2 in native elemental environment.
Endurance Runner	1	[Fauna]	Reduce chained Move SP surcharge by 1 once/round.
Energy Absorbing	4	[Supernatural]	DR 2 to Affinity. Heal for damage prevented.
Epiphytic Growth	2	[Flora]	Attach to surfaces. Climb at half speed. No soil needed.
Exoskeleton	2	[Fauna]	¼ Slashing, ½ Piercing, ×2 Bashing.
Explosive Escape	2	[Universal]	Create flash/sound/gas to escape.
Fang/Claw	1	[Fauna]	Piercing attacks ignore 2 PDR.
Fast Spreading	1	[Flora]	Recover 1 HP/round stationary in natural terrain.
Fearsome Displays	2	[Universal]	Intimidate enemies, −2 enemy defense.
Feign Death	1	[Universal]	SPT vs MND to convincingly feign death.
Fleshy Fruits	2	[Flora]	Produce fruit/rest. Allies recover 2 HP and 2 SP.
Frost Tolerant	1	[Universal]	+2 Cold DR. No SP penalty in cold.
Fungal Network Clarity	2	[Flora][Fungal]	MPR +1 in natural terrain.
Fur	1	[Fauna]	+2 Cold DR. +1 Bashing Defense.
Gas Bladder	2	[Fauna]	−25% weight, +1 Takeoff.
Gestural Language	2	[Universal]	Full language through body/hands/color. Silent.
Glial Density	1	[Natural][Universal]	MPR +1. Pure neural efficiency.
Golem Stillness	2	[Supernatural]	HPR +3 when fully stationary 1 round.
Groundsense	1	[Universal]	×2 Notice grounded. Tracking [context: vibration].
Gut-Brain Axis	1	[Natural][Fauna]	MPR +1. Req: Language.

Heartwood	3	[Natural][Flora]	HPR +2 stationary, HPR +1 moving.
Heat Resist	2	[Universal]	+2 DR and saves vs Fire.
Heat Vision	2	[Fauna]	See heat signatures. ×2 Notice vs Warm-blooded.
Heavy-Set	1	[Fauna]	Gain Quicken after moving.
Helium Gas Bladder	2	[Fauna]	Prereq: Wings + mineral-rich diet. Passive buoyancy flight. Dense bones intact. Puncture vulnerability.
Herbaceous	1	[Flora]	HPR +1. ×2 Fire damage taken.
Hibernate	1	[Fauna]	Become unconscious. HPR ×5 until awoken.
Hibernate Recovery	2	[Natural][Fauna]	HPR ×3 while Hibernating. Cannot act but aware.
Hollow Bones	1	[Fauna]	+5 SPD, +2 vs Slashing, −10% weight.
Hollow Stems	1	[Flora]	+1 SPD. −10% weight. −1 vs Bashing.
Hooves	1	[Fauna]	+1 SPD on hard terrain.
Hydra Regrowth	4	[Supernatural]	Taking 10+ damage: HPR +3 for 2 rounds.
Immortal	4	[Supernatural]	Revives in chosen/random location when slain.
Incorporeal	4	[Supernatural]	Immune to physical damage. Weak to magic.
Ink Cloud	2	[Fauna]	1 AP, 1 SP: Obscuring 2 tiles 1 round.
Insectile Wings	2	[Fauna]	+1 Hover checks. Cannot Glide. +50% SP Takeoff.
Instinctual Signaling	1	[Universal]	Communicate emotion/intent. Understood by same species.
Kami Renewal	3	[Supernatural]	MPR +2 natural/sacred. MPR +0 urban.
Keen Perception — Sight	2	[Universal]	Halve crit success range on sight checks.
Keen Smell	1	[Fauna]	+4 scent detect. Tracking [context: scent].
Ki-Sight	3	[Supernatural]	See energies, auras, and magical flows.
Language	3	[Universal]	Full symbolic communication. One language. −1 MPR.
Lateral Line	2	[Fauna]	×2 Notice vs moving targets in water.
Leader	2	[Universal]	+2 on Leader skills.
Levitation Core	3	[Supernatural]	Hover: +5 SPD, +1 Hover.
Low-Light Vision	1	[Universal]	See in very dim light.
Meditative Rest	2	[Natural][Supernatural]	4-hour conscious rest. MPR +1. Immune to sleep effects.
Memory Recall	1	[Universal]	+2 to remembering obscure knowledge.
Mimicry	2	[Universal]	Copy sound/movement/ability used last round.
Monocot Awareness	1	[Flora]	Aware of underground water within Bio Rank × 20 ft.
Mucous Coat	1	[Fauna]	+1 DR vs Slashing. −1 DR vs Cold.
Multilingual	2	[Universal]	One additional language per purchase. Repeatable.

Mycorrhizal Cognition	1	[Natural][Fungal]	MPR +1. Req: Language or Mycorrhizal Network.
Mycorrhizal Network	3	[Flora][Fungal]	Silent communication with Flora/Fungal allies.
Mycorrhizal Symbiosis	2	[Flora][Fungal]	MPR +1 natural terrain. Aware of creatures in soil.
Myelin Efficiency	2	[Natural][Fauna]	MPR +1. +1 die on first MND check each combat.
Night-Blooming Sense	2	[Flora]	Low-Light Vision. +2 MNT checks at night.
Night Vision	1	[Universal]	Enhanced low-light clarity.
Nitrogen-Fixing Roots	2	[Flora][Prokaryote]	Max HP +3. Resting allies gain HPR +1.
Pack Coordination	2	[Fauna]	+1 attack when ally within 10 ft of target.
Parasitic (trait)	2	[Universal]	Hitting infected enemies restores 1 HP, SP, MP.
Phylactery Tether	4	[Advanced][Supernatural]	MPR +3. Reform at phylactery after Bio Rank hours.
Phoenix Surge	4	[Supernatural][Advanced]	HPR +2. Once/long rest recover Bio Rank HP at 0.
Photosynthetic Recovery	2	[Natural][Flora]	SPR +1 in sunlight. SPR +0 in shade.
Planarian Reconstruction	4	[Natural][Advanced]	HPR +3. Reconstruct from 0 HP over 1 hour.
Pods	1	[Flora]	Store 3 small items. Release as projectile: 1 piercing.
Poison Resist	2	[Universal]	+2 DR and saves vs Poison. Rank 2 minimum.
Pounce	2	[Fauna]	Moved ≥2 tiles toward unaware target: +1 damage die.
Predator's Mark	2	[Fauna]	Mark a target. +2 to attack it.
Psion Cycling	3	[Supernatural]	MPR +2. MP spent returns 1 MPR next round.
Pungent Oils	2	[Flora]	Aura 1 tile: save or −1 MND checks.
Quickened Recovery	2	[Universal]	SPR +1.
Rapid Growth	2	[Flora]	HPR +2. Visible regrowth within 1 round.
Rapid Lifecycle	2	[Flora]	Once/long rest shed and regrow to remove condition.
Rapid Regen	3	[Natural][Fauna]	HPR +2. Regrow lost appendages over Bio Rank days.
Regenerant	2	[Universal]	HPR +1.
Root-Neural Network	1	[Natural][Flora]	MPR +1. Req: Language or Complex Flower Signal.
Selkie Attunement	2	[Natural][Supernatural]	SPR +2 within 10 ft of natural water.
Skilled	2	[Universal]	Gain one skill at Rank 1 with +1 on checks.
Sleep Architecture	2	[Natural][Fauna]	MPR +2. Requires 6–8 hours sleep per long rest.
Soft Stems	1	[Flora]	½ Bashing. ×2 Slashing. Squeeze 1 size smaller.

Spiked Defense	2	[Universal]	Melee attackers take 2 piercing damage.
Spore Cloud	2	[Fungal]	1 AP: 1 tile Obscuring + Poison 1 stack on entry.
Stone Memory	2	[Stonekin]	Read emotional/historical resonance of stone. +Bio Rank on History/Investigation.
Stone Skin Shed	3	[Stonekin]	Remove one physical condition. -1 PDR 1 hour. Rank 4+: throw as Bio Rank damage obstacle.
Stealthy	1	[Universal]	+4 to Stealth checks.
Symbiote Sharing	3	[Exotic]	SPR +1. Ally within 5 ft may use your SPR once/round.
Telepathic Link	3	[Supernatural]	Silent communication with allies and tamed beasts.
Territorial	1	[Universal]	+2 attack defending home terrain.
Thick Hide	2	[Universal]	¼ Bashing, ½ Slashing, ×2 Piercing.
Tool User	1	[Universal]	+2 to tool-related checks.
Toxic Fruit	2	[Flora]	Produce toxic fruit. Save vs Poison 2.
Tribal	1	[Universal]	+2 flanking bonus with allies.
Troll Mending	3	[Supernatural]	HPR +2. Suppressed 1 round after Fire or Acid.
Vampire Feeding	3	[Supernatural]	After dealing HP damage: HPR +2 until end of next round.
Undeath I — Animate Dead	3	[Supernatural]	No Max SP. All SP costs→HP costs. SPR→HPR. Biological MPR suppressed. MPR 0.
Undeath II — Sustained	3	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Undeath I. Basic necromantic maintenance. Vampire Feeding free prereq. MPR -1.
Undeath III — Preserved	4	[Supernatural]	Prereq: Undeath II. Full maintenance. Can pass as living. +2 PDR. MPR -2.
Undeath IV — Awakened	4	[Supernatural][Advanced]	Prereq: Undeath III. Genuine undead systems. Undead Affinity free. Cannot pass as living. MPR -2.
Undeath V — Transcendent	4	[Supernatural][Advanced]	Prereq: Undeath IV + Phylactery Tether. Immortal. Phylactery integrated. +4 PDR. MPR -3.
Venomous	2	[Universal]	Inflicts Poison through attacks or contact.
Versatile Adaptation	2	[Universal]	Once/long rest gain Rank 1 proficiency for 1 hour.
Vertical Growth	1	[Flora]	+1 tile reach. Scales with Bio Rank.
Vivid Blooms	1	[Flora]	+2 Persuasion/Distraction when blooming.
Vocalizer	2	[Fauna]	Learned sound production. Grants Mimicry [sound]. 0 MPR.
Warm-Blooded	1	[Fauna]	+1 HPR when Warm. +1 SPR when Cool.
Webbed	1	[Natural][Fauna]	+1 swim SPD. Path to Amphibious.
White Eyes	2	[Universal]	Total darkness sight. Blinded by bright light.
Whole-Body Recovery	3	[Universal]	HPR +1, SPR +1, MPR +1.
Wide-Angle Vision	1	[Universal]	Increased field of view. Prevents flanking.

Wind Pollination Sense	1	[Flora]	+2 ranged accuracy in wind.
Widespread	1	[Flora]	+4 Stealth stationary in natural terrain.
Written Language	2	[Universal]	Encode and decode symbolic writing.

Diet

One selection per creature at creation. Grants Max HP/SP/MP bonuses representing lifelong feeding adaptation — the longest-running experience of any creature's life. [Supernatural] diets require a [Supernatural] trait.

Diet	Max HP	Max SP	Max MP	Kingdom Tags	Biological Basis
Carnivore	+2	+2	—	[Fauna]	High protein and fat; tissue and activity
Herbivore	—	+4	—	[Fauna]	Carbohydrate-rich; pure energy
Omnivore	+1	+2	+1	[Fauna]	Balanced macronutrients across all pools
Scavenger	+2	—	+2	[Fauna]	Decomposed matter; protein-dense, complex compounds
Insectivore	—	—	+4	[Fauna]	Chitin and alkaloids; neurochemically stimulating
Hemovore	+4	—	—	[Fauna]	Pure protein and iron; maximally structural
Filter Feeder	—	+2	+2	[Fauna]	Suspended microorganisms; mineral-rich
Detritivore	+1	+1	+2	[Fauna]	Dead organic matter; modest and broadly distributed
Photosynthetic	—	+4	—	[Flora][Protist][Prokaryote]	Solar energy conversion; pure SP capacity
Carnivorous Plant	+2	—	+2	[Flora]	Photosynthesis plus prey nitrogen
Mycotrophic	+1	—	+3	[Flora]	Fungal network minerals; heavily cognitive
Parasitic	+1	+1	+1	[Flora][Fungal][Protist][Prokaryote]	Opportunistic host-feeding; total 3 (not 4)
Saprotrophic	+2	—	+2	[Fungal][Prokaryote]	Decomposed matter; mineral-dense
Mycorrhizal	+1	+2	+1	[Fungal]	Mutualistic root-network exchange; balanced
Predatory Fungi	+2	+2	—	[Fungal]	Active prey capture; protein-rich
Phagotrophic	+1	+2	+1	[Protist]	Engulfs whole cells; full nutritional absorption
Osmotrophic	—	+2	+2	[Protist][Prokaryote]	Passive dissolved absorption; mineral-rich
Chemosynthetic	+2	—	+2	[Prokaryote]	Converts inorganic compounds; no sunlight needed
Nitrogen-Fixing	+3	—	+1	[Prokaryote]	Atmospheric nitrogen conversion; highly structural
Animavore	—	+4	—	[Supernatural]	Consumes soul energy. Requires [Supernatural] trait.
Psychevore	—	—	+4	[Supernatural]	Consumes thought. Requires [Supernatural] trait.

Lineage Archetypes

Lineage Archetype is the cultural and epigenetic inheritance — what the creature's ancestors survived through over generations. This shapes which traits are **naturally available** at Biology Rank 1 from the Compensation Pool. The archetype is a **recommendation, not a constraint**. Players spend their Rank 1 pool however they choose. The archetype is a starting conversation about where your character comes from.

Design Philosophy

Lineage Archetype represents generational behavioral encoding — the biological residue of what worked for a lineage over centuries of survival. This is epigenetics, not stereotype.

A creature raised far from their ancestral culture still carries these tendencies in their biology. They can express them, ignore them, or build against them — that is the player's choice.

The archetype makes certain Rank 1 traits feel natural. It does not make them mandatory.

Archetype	Survival Strategy	Rank 1 Variation Tendencies
Agrarian Collective	Precision farming, long-term planning, communal resource management	Disciplined, Tool User, Memory Recall, Cultured
Nomadic Herder	Territorial range, individual decision-making, animal husbandry	Territorial, Keen Smell, Endurance Runner, Wide-Angle Vision
Maritime Trader	Navigation, negotiation, risk across cultures	Cultured, Multilingual (if Language held), Webbed, Amphibious path
Warrior Caste	Combat doctrine, hierarchy, controlled aggression	Fearsome Displays, Disciplined, Leader, Tribal
Isolated Mountain	Harsh environment, self-sufficiency, close-knit kin groups	Frost Tolerant, Dense Bones, Territorial, Memory Recall
Jungle / Swamp	Camouflage, toxin exposure, opportunistic predation	Stealthy, Poison Resist, Ambusher, Keen Smell
Desert Nomad	Heat endurance, resource conservation, astronomical navigation	Heat Resist, Endurance Runner, Memory Recall, Wide-Angle Vision
Scholarly Caste	Knowledge preservation, pattern recognition, social hierarchy	Memory Recall, Cultured, Glial Density, Written Language
Hunter-Gatherer	Tracking, seasonal awareness, small group coordination	Keen Smell, Stealthy, Groundsense, Pack Coordination
Coastal Fisher	Tidal awareness, net coordination, weather reading	Webbed, Amphibious path, Pack Coordination, Keen Perception
Subterranean	Dark adaptation, vibration sensing, mineral knowledge	Low-Light Vision, Groundsense, Dense Bones, Stealthy
Aristocratic	Inherited authority, refined manner, resource abundance	Cultured, Leader, Disciplined, Written Language

Elven Example Build — Humanoid + Scholarly Caste + Isolated Mountain blend

Rank 1 PHY pool (~10 TP): Low-Light Vision (1) + Night Vision (1) + Glial Density (1) = 3 TP spent.

Remaining 7 TP held for Rank 2 access.

Rank 1 SOC pool (~2 TP): Memory Recall already free. Hold for Cultured at Rank 2.

Rank 2 (2 XP): Meditative Rest (2) + Dark Vision (2) + Cultured (2) + Multilingual (2) = 8 TP.

By Rank 2 this Humanoid is recognizably Elven: meditates instead of sleeping, sees in darkness, culturally refined, speaks multiple languages. Built through trait choices, not racial exceptions.

Size — Combat Interaction Table

Size modifiers apply to Combat rolls only. Stats cannot go negative from size modifiers. Medium is the standard player reference size.

Size	SPD	Area	vs Tiny	vs Small	vs Medium	vs Large	vs Huge+
Tiny	10	1 ft	N/A	-1 BDY +1 SPT	-2 BDY +2 SPT	-3 BDY +3 SPT	-4 BDY +4 SPT
Small	15	3 ft	+1 BDY -1 SPT	N/A	-1 BDY +1 SPT	-2 BDY +2 SPT	-3 BDY +3 SPT
Medium	20	5 ft	+2 BDY -2 SPT	+1 BDY -1 SPT	N/A	-1 BDY +1 SPT	-2 BDY +2 SPT
Large	25	10 ft	+3 BDY -3 SPT	+2 BDY -2 SPT	+1 BDY -1 SPT	N/A	-1 BDY +1 SPT
Huge	30	20 ft	+4 BDY -4 SPT	+3 BDY -3 SPT	+2 BDY -2 SPT	+1 BDY -1 SPT	N/A
Gigantic	35	40 ft	+5 BDY -5 SPT	+4 BDY -4 SPT	+3 BDY -3 SPT	+2 BDY -2 SPT	+1 BDY -1 SPT

Biology Types — Fey & Stonekin

Two formally designed Biology Types added in v4.3. Fey uses an overlay tag system. Stonekin is a Fauna Biology Type.

Fey Biology Type

Fey is not a separate kingdom. The **[Fey]** tag overlays any existing kingdom — a creature can be [Fauna][Fey], [Flora][Fey], or [Fungal][Fey]. Fey biology represents genetic memory: a lineage that passed through the thought-plane at some point and retained the resonance. The thought-plane is an ascendant plane adjacent to the physical world — more material than a spiritual plane but more mutable than the physical one. Change is its only inevitable.

Fey Design Philosophy

Fey are well-informed because the thought-plane bleeds information as a byproduct of existence near it.
Fey are mischievous because they perceive the gap between what others know and what they know.
Fey bodies are real and material but more responsive — they reflect mental and emotional state more directly than purely physical creatures.

Biology Rank for Fey represents deepening connection to the thought-plane:
Rank 1 — latent inheritance, barely expressing
Rank 3 — thought-plane awareness is active and reliable
Rank 5 — the creature is almost as much thought-plane as physical world

Diet: Animavore (deeply connected — feeds on emotional residue of significant moments)
OR Omnivore (physically grounded — plane connection expresses through perception, not feeding).
The choice reflects the creature's relationship to their Fey inheritance.

Fey Biology Type	Details
Kingdom Tag	[Fey] — overlays existing kingdom. Creature retains base kingdom tag. [Fey] traits require [Fey] tag.
Free Traits (Rank 1)	Keen Perception — Sight (T2, MNT, 2 TP), Memory Recall (T1, MNT, 1 TP), Instinctual Signaling (T1, SOC, 1 TP). Free total: 4 TP.
Rank 1 Pool	Mimicry (T2), Stealthy (T1), Glial Density (T1), Feign Death (T1)
Rank 2 Pool	Fey Impression (T2, unique), Fey Glamour (T3, unique), Meditative Rest (T2), Ki-Sight (T3), Gestural Language (T2), Versatile Adaptation (T2)
Rank 3 Pool	Attuned (T4), Blessed (T4), Telepathic Link (T3)
Rank 4 Pool	Phylactery Tether (T4)
Morphotype	Any morphotype whose base kingdom matches the [Fey] creature's kingdom. A Fey Humanoid is still a Humanoid. A Fey Sylvan Form is still a Sylvan Form.

Fey Impression (T2, MNT, Rank 2, [Fey])

The thought-plane leaves marks on significant moments. When a Fey creature witnesses an emotionally significant event — a death, a declaration, a betrayal, a moment of pure joy — they retain a perfect sensory impression of it indefinitely. Mechanically: +2 on all checks involving events the Fey personally witnessed. The GM may feed the Fey passive information through the impression — the thought-plane noticed details the player

didn't. At Rank 4+: impressions extend to places. Touching a location where significant events occurred grants awareness of those events even without having witnessed them.

Fey Glamour (T3, SOC, Rank 2, [Fey])

Prereq: Fey Impression. The thought-plane's malleability lets Fey alter perceived form. The body itself doesn't change — perception of it does. Creatures interacting with the Fey see what the Fey intends within reason. Mechanically: Disguise and Deception checks gain +Bio Rank bonus. Creatures with Ki-Sight, Keen Perception — Sight, or Meditative Rest may attempt to pierce the glamour with a MND check vs the Fey's SOC Rank × 2. At Rank 4+: the glamour extends to one willing creature within touch range.

Fey Flora Expression

Fey Flora creatures express the thought-plane connection through directed growth — extravagant, intentional, curiosity-driven. A Fey vine explores because it is curious. A walking flower reroots itself because it chooses where to be. A sentient tree is ancient and deeply aware of everything that has occurred in its presence. Where Fey Fauna perceives and reacts, Fey Flora grows toward what interests it.

Fey Flora — Thought-Plane Through Growth

Locomotion expresses curiosity rather than survival. Climbing Vines and Vertical Growth become extensions of the creature's desire to reach interesting things.

Fey Impression in Flora expresses through root contact — a Fey tree rooted for decades has absorbed the impression of centuries.

Fey Glamour in Flora expresses as sudden bloom — overwhelming display when wanting to be noticed, complete closure when wanting to hide. The creature looks like any other plant.

The rerooting rhythm defines the lifestyle: move, explore, root, absorb, move again.

Long rests taken while rooted yield deeper knowledge than those taken on the move.

Unique trait available to [Fey][Flora] only: Root Dreaming (T2, MNT, Rank 2)

Root Dreaming (T2, MNT, Rank 2, [Fey][Flora])

When a Fey Flora creature completes a long rest while rooted in natural soil, they absorb the emotional and historical resonance of the land beneath them. After a rooted long rest the GM provides one piece of true information about significant events that occurred in the region, scaled to the depth and age of the soil. Undisturbed ancient earth holds deeper and older memories than recently worked ground. At Rank 3+: the creature may ask one specific question about the land's history and receive a truthful answer if the memory exists in the soil. At Rank 5: continuous passive awareness of significant events occurring within Bio Rank x 100 ft while rooted — the land reports to them.

Fey Flora Pool Additions	Details
Additional Rank 1	Climbing Vines (T2), Vertical Growth (T1), Widespread (T1) — locomotion as curiosity
Additional Rank 2	Root Dreaming (T2, unique), Composite Signal (T2), Mycorrhizal Symbiosis (T2)
Additional Rank 3	Mycorrhizal Network (T3), Rapid Lifecycle (T2)
Fey base traits	All Fey Fauna pool traits remain available. [Fey][Flora] creatures access both lists.

Fey Fungal Expression

Fey Fungal creatures express the thought-plane connection through distributed network consciousness — the physical mushroom body is almost incidental, a visible node of something much larger. The thought-plane connection transforms the mycelium from chemical signaling into genuine thought transmission. Their mischief is informational: they know everything about everyone who has walked their soil, and occasionally they let someone know they are known.

Fey Fungal — Thought-Plane as Network

Physical dormancy is a feature, not a limitation. When the body is still, the mind is most active.

The mycelial network is a literal extension of consciousness, not just a communication channel.

Fey Impression in Fungal expresses through mycelial contact — any creature whose biological material has touched connected soil leaves an emotional trace readable by the network.

A Fey Fungal community shares impressions automatically. Individual identity remains intact but warnings and strong emotions propagate instantly through connected mycelium.

The network cannot be magically silenced without severing the physical mycelium — it is not a psychic signal. It is a physical signal made fast by the thought-plane.

Unique traits available to [Fey][Fungal] only: Mycelial Memory (T2), Hive Thought (T3)

Mycelial Memory (T2, MNT, Rank 2, [Fey][Fungal])

The mycelial network retains impressions from every creature it has ever been in contact with. Automatic Fey Impression effect for any creature whose biological material — footprints, shed cells, blood, hair — is present in soil connected to the Fey Fungal's network. The impression is fragmentary: emotional tone and strong memories rather than full sensory replay. At Rank 3+: the creature can send a single thought to any creature currently in contact with connected soil, even unknowingly. The recipient experiences it as a stray thought or vivid feeling with no apparent source.

Hive Thought (T3, SOC, Rank 3, [Fey][Fungal])

Prereq: Mycelial Memory + Mycorrhizal Network. A community of Fey Fungal creatures sharing connected mycelium share a partial consciousness. Individual identity remains fully intact but impressions, warnings, and strong emotions propagate instantly through the network. All [Fey][Fungal] creatures sharing a connected network act as if they have Telepathic Link at no range limit while the network connection is intact. If one member perceives a threat or witnesses a significant event, all connected members become aware within one round.

Fey Fungal Pool Additions	Details
Additional Rank 1	Mycorrhizal Symbiosis (T2), Groundsense (T1), Spore Cloud (T2)
Additional Rank 2	Mycelial Memory (T2, unique), Mycelial Cognition (T1)
Additional Rank 3	Hive Thought (T3, unique), Mycorrhizal Network (T3)
Fey base traits	All Fey Fauna pool traits remain available. [Fey][Fungal] creatures access both lists.

Fey Kingdom Expression Summary

Kingdom	Thought-Plane Expression	Unique Traits	Mobility Pattern	Mischief Style
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[Fauna]	Perception and memory — sees more than is visible	Fey Impression, Fey Glamour	Normal locomotion	Personal and active
[Flora]	Directed growth — grows toward what interests it	Fey Impression, Fey Glamour, Root Dreaming	Explore then reroot	Environmental, spatial
[Fungal]	Network consciousness — body is a node of something larger	Fey Impression, Mycelial Memory, Hive Thought	Physically dormant, mentally vast	Informational — knows all, reveals selectively

Stonekin Biology Type

Stonekin are Fauna. They reproduce, mature through Biology Ranks, hold individual souls in individual bodies, and die when their body is sufficiently damaged. Their stone composition is their biology — mineral-crystal bones, compressed sediment skin, mineral-rich fluid for blood. They run warm because the tight soul-body relationship generates internal heat the same way mammalian metabolism does.

Stonekin Design Philosophy

In the Ciretose setting, Stonekin (Dwarves) were created by early primordial gods from earth given life. They did not evolve — they were made with intention. Biology Rank progression represents coming into alignment with the original intention of creation. A Stonekin at Rank 5 is closer to what their maker envisioned than a Stonekin at Rank 1.

Soul-body relationship: as close as a human's. Unlike Elemental Forms where the soul is diffuse, a Stonekin's soul is fully in their body. They are not earth that acts like a person. They are a person who happens to be made of earth. This distinction matters for every system.

Diet: Detritivore or Saprotrophic most common — mineral-processing, feeding on decomposed matter. Carnivore possible for aggressive Stonekin lineages.

Stonekin Biology Type	Details
Kingdom	[Fauna]. Stonekin are living creatures with individual souls. They reproduce and mature normally.
Free Traits (Rank 1)	Dense Bones (T1, PHY, 1 TP), Thick Hide (T2, PHY, 2 TP), Groundsense (T1, MNT, 1 TP), Warm-Blooded (T1, PHY, 1 TP), Stone Memory (T2, MNT, 2 TP). Free total: 7 TP.
Rank 1 Pool	Heavy-Set (T1), Poison Resist (T2), Burrower (T2), Tool User (T1), Immoveable ★ Stat Trait
Rank 2 Pool	Disciplined (T2), Golem Stillness (T2), Electoreceptive Clarity (T2)
Rank 3 Pool	Stone Skin Shed (T3, unique), Energy Absorbing (T4), Whole-Body Recovery (T3)
Morphotype	Humanoid most common. Bipedal Beast possible. Any Fauna morphotype with GM approval.

Stone Memory (T2, MNT, Rank 1, [Stonekin])

Stone remembers. A Stonekin in contact with worked or natural stone for at least one minute reads the emotional and historical resonance of significant events that occurred near it. Older stone holds deeper memory. Mechanically: History and Investigation checks related to a location gain +Bio Rank bonus when physically touching the stone of that place. At Rank 3+: passive awareness of strong historical resonance within Bio Rank ×

5 ft without concentration. At Rank 5: the Stonekin can communicate a stone impression to others through touch — sharing it as a full action.

Stone Skin Shed (T3, PHY, Rank 3, [Stonekin])

Once per long rest the Stonekin sheds their outermost stone layer — a controlled but painful process that removes one negative physical condition (poisoned, bleeding, burning, corroding) along with the compromised material. The new layer beneath is temporarily softer: -1 PDR for 1 hour, then fully hardened. At Rank 4+: the shed layer can be used offensively as a thrown obstacle — 1 AP, Bio Rank bludgeoning damage, 10 ft range, creates difficult terrain on the landing tile.

Kingdom Tag Clarification

A creature's Biology Type kingdom determines which tagged traits are available for purchase from their pool. [Fauna] traits may only be purchased by Fauna creatures. [Flora] traits by Flora creatures. [Fungal] by Fungal creatures. [Universal] traits are available to all kingdoms. [Fey] traits require the [Fey] overlay tag regardless of base kingdom. A creature with both [Fauna] and [Fey] tags may purchase from both access lists.

Open Design Questions

Flagged for Resolution — v4.3

1. FEY BIOLOGY TYPE — Formally designed in v4.3. Fey Impression and Fey Glamour unique traits included. Playtest needed to confirm Rank 1 free trait value (4 TP) vs pool overhead.
2. STONEKIN BIOLOGY TYPE — Formally designed in v4.3. Stone Memory and Stone Skin Shed unique traits included.
Confirm diet options (Detritivore / Saprotrophic / Carnivore) in playtesting.
3. UNDEAD TRAIT SUB-TREE — Referenced in Undeath Tier II as unlocking access to Undead trait sub-tree. Sub-tree traits (Deathless, Necrotic Feeding, Undying Resilience, Corpse Resilience, Torpor) are flagged for a future design pass. Vampire Feeding serves as the interim core undead offensive trait.
4. FLORA BIOLOGY TYPE LISTS — Asteraceae, Fabaceae, Orchidaceae, Poaceae, Brassicaceae, Liliaceae, Rosaceae, Solanaceae, Apiaceae — unique trait access distinctions pending.
5. FEY FLORA AND FEY FUNGAL — [Fey] tag confirmed as overlay on all kingdoms. Unique Fey traits are kingdom-agnostic but expressions in Flora and Fungal contexts need narrative examples.